

EVE GLYPH DESIGN · HAWKINS TWIN · PETERBILT ATLANTIC · L2 NOTE

# The composite, and what sits under it

Why the ADA 20 Group composite is the right vocabulary and the wrong instrument — and what a data twin adds underneath it without changing a single line name.

The 20 Group composite is the most disciplined instrument in the dealership. It is also a photograph taken once a month of a business that changes every hour, and it reports position without reporting cause. What follows is not a new scorecard. It is a layer underneath the existing one — the same ATD line items, recomputed continuously from the systems that already produce them, each variance carrying a named cause and an owner. Tim keeps speaking the association's language in the room; the twin does the arithmetic between meetings.

**Illustrative figures.** Line names, formulas and guides below are public ATD figures; the Hawkins column is invented to show the shape of the instrument. No Hawkins data has been read. The real frame is cut once the composite export lands (HT-01).

## 1. What the composite is, structurally

ATD publishes roughly forty formulas with guide values attached — fixed absorption at 115%, total absorption at 130%, parts months' supply at 1.5, obsolescence under 3%, first-time fill at 90%, technician proficiency at 100%, used-truck days' supply at 60. The 20 Group collects those definitions from every member and returns each dealer his own column beside the group average and the best performer. Three properties make it valuable, one makes it insufficient. It is **standardised** — the same numerator over the same denominator everywhere, so comparison is real rather than rhetorical. It is **peer-anchored** — the benchmark is dealers of the same franchise and scale, not a national aggregate. It is **adversarial in the right way** — a member cannot argue with a line item his peers also report. And it is **retrospective** — it closes a period, arrives weeks later, and answers where without answering why or who.

## 2. The layer underneath

A data twin is a continuously reconciled mirror of the operating record — parts, VIN inventory, repair orders, receivables, call traffic — held in the dealership's own tenancy. It replaces no system and invents no metric. It recomputes the association's own line items on live data and keeps the transaction detail behind each one, so a variance decomposes into the movements that caused it. The composite says fill rate is below guide; the twin says which lines missed, at which centre, against which demand, and which transfer closes the gap.

| ATD LINE ITEM                 | MONTHLY  | LIVE     | GUIDE   | WHAT THE TWIN ADDS UNDERNEATH                                                   |
|-------------------------------|----------|----------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Parts fill rate — first time  | 86.7%    | 91.3%    | 90.0%   | The 56 stockout events by centre and part, and the 40 transfers that close them |
| Parts obsolescence >12 months | 4.1%     | 4.1%     | <3.0%   | The 297 overstock lines ranked by carrying cost against forward demand          |
| Open repair orders            | 4.3 days | 4.3 days | <2 days | The specific ROs sitting past last time punch, by advisor and technician        |
| Used-truck days' supply       | 88 days  | 88 days  | 60 days | The unit-level ageing tail and the floor plan cost each unit is accruing        |
| Warranty receivables >30 days | \$186.4k | \$186.4k | \$0     | Claim-level ageing against the manufacturer portal, chaseable the same day      |

## 3. Why this is the ordering that works

### Top down

The composite defines the target set. Nothing gets built that does not move a line item Tim already reports to his peers — no invented metric, no translation layer, no argument about whether the number matters.

### Bottom up

The operational problems that already exist are the proving ground. The phone system first — cheap, self-contained, and nobody's revenue depends on it while it is mirrored. Then parts. Then the receivable tail.

### Sovereign by construction

The twin sits in the dealership's own cloud tenancy, reading from the systems of record and writing nowhere. Ownership of the data and the model is a precondition, not a feature — and it is what makes the work fundable as research.

### Portable by design

Because the line items belong to the association rather than any vendor, the same frame drops onto any dealer in the group. What is built here is offerable to the peers around the table.

## 4. What to ask for in the room

- Authorisation to pull the current ADA composite export, so this mock frame is replaced by the real line names.
- Read access to the phone platform's call records — the first proof, built at no cost, measured on missed calls by department.
- The DMS, phone and managed-service agreements, read before any credential is issued.
- A written, capped engagement between the dealership and EVEglyphDesign, with the data-handling terms named in it.

Line items, formulas and guides: American Truck Dealers, 2026 Formulas, Definitions and Guides — [slideguide.nada.org/ATDSlideGuide.pdf](https://slideguide.nada.org/ATDSlideGuide.pdf) · ATD Data annual financial profile — [nada.org/atd/research/atd-data](https://nada.org/atd/research/atd-data) · NADA/ATD 20 Group — [nada.org/nada/nada-20-group](https://nada.org/nada/nada-20-group). Interactive companion, all 41 line items across five departments: [eveglyph-design.github.io/hawkins-twin-platform/composite/](https://eveglyph-design.github.io/hawkins-twin-platform/composite/) · Next-steps register HT-01-HT-16 and repository: [github.com/EVEglyphDesign/hawkins-twin-platform](https://github.com/EVEglyphDesign/hawkins-twin-platform)